Final Project for the Harward's Graduate Masterclass on Entering Global Academia

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in collaboration with Alona Motiashova

Dear Curators of the Masterclass:

In order to prove that we have learned how to implement the knowledge from the course, we have decided to extend the research over the data on the birth and death of Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers.

We have decided to implement some of the approaches seen during the course:

First- collaborative aspect, we have decided to collaborate with additional researchers in order to extend the research productivity, so we collaborated with Alona Motiashova [BA in Information Systems and Technologies, National Technical University of Ukraine "Igor Sikorsky Kyiv Polytechnic Institute"]. As a result, the data covers 266 Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers analyzed in collaboration and 149 Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers analyzed manually rather than 100, which we analyzed during the start of the semester. We have totally analyzed 415 Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers. The data covers Ukrainian Creative Workers who died after 1922, died before 1991, and were born before 1975.

Second- use of modern digital technologies- instead of physically reading through the biography of 266 artists, using skills of Alona Motiashova, we have managed to use Open AI [Chat GPTs source code] to analyze each biography automatically and determine the migration status. Data was then hand-checked, and AI's mistakes were fixed. As a result, AI has made mistakes in about 20% of the cases, half needing deep analysis by human hand and a half were just casual mistakes. As a result, we have a much more significant amount of data to explore.

Third- Tableau. Data was then visualized using Tableau. (Some data was visualized in Google Sheets in collaboration with Alona Motiashova).

The goal of the research was to show the Life Length of Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers During the Soviet Occupation of Ukraine, In Comparison to those who Migrated, as well as to show their age of death during the popular death years in order to prove that Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers that have stayed in USSR were not dying of natural causes.

Methodology:

This research project aimed to investigate the life length of Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers during the Soviet occupation of Ukraine, comparing those who remained in Ukraine to those who migrated. As well as to show their age of death during the popular death years in order to justify the statement that Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers that have stayed in USSR were not dying of natural causes.
The methodology encompassed three main aspects: collaboration, utilization of modern digital technologies, and data visualization.

Collaboration: To enhance research productivity and broaden the scope of analysis, collaboration with Alona Motiashova, a researcher with a Bachelor's degree in Information Systems and Technologies from the National Technical University of Ukraine "Igor Sikorsky Kyiv Polytechnic Institute," was established. The collaboration resulted in the analysis of 266 Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers, conducted collaboratively, and an additional 149 workers analyzed manually. Initially, only 100 workers were analyzed at the start of the semester. In total, 415 Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers were analyzed. The inclusion criteria for the data were individuals who died after 1922, died before 1991, and were born before 1975.

Use of Modern Digital Technologies: To streamline the analysis process and handle a larger dataset, modern digital technologies were employed. Alona Motiashova utilized OpenAI's Chat GPTs source code to automatically analyze each worker's biography and determine their migration status. The data obtained from AI analysis was then subjected to manual verification, where errors made by the AI were identified and corrected. The AI made mistakes in approximately 20% of the cases, requiring in-depth analysis by humans in half of the cases, while the remaining half consisted of casual mistakes. Despite these errors, the utilization of AI significantly increased the amount of data available for exploration and analysis.

Data Visualization: The analyzed data was visualized using Tableau, a data visualization software, with some visualization conducted in collaboration with Alona Motiashova using Google Sheets. Visualization played a crucial role in presenting the findings effectively and facilitating data interpretation.

The primary objective of the research was to demonstrate the life length of Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers during the Soviet occupation of Ukraine and compare it with those who migrated. Additionally, the study aimed to highlight the age of death of these workers during popular death years to refute the notion that Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers who remained in the USSR were dying of natural causes. However, a significant methodological issue was encountered, as the study only included individuals who died before 1991. It was observed that many Ukrainian Creative Workers who migrated outlived the Soviet Union, and a substantial number are still alive today. Consequently, the statistical analysis tends to be pessimistic towards individuals who migrated.

Examples involve: Vasyl′ Barka 1908-2003, Víra Vovk 1926-2022, Hala Mazurenko 1901-2000, Natalia Liwycka-Chołodna 1902-2005, George Shevelov 1908-2002, Ivan Koshelivets͡′ 1907-1999, Tetyana Kardynalovska 1899-1993.

Exceptions to the migration categorization were also considered in the analysis. Creative Workers who were killed by Soviet authorities during the occupation of certain territories of former Poland were classified as non-migrated, as their cause of death was directly attributable to the Soviet occupation. Likewise, Creative Workers who migrated and subsequently returned to the Soviet Union to die were also categorized as non-migrated. Furthermore, Creative Workers who were allowed to migrate due to poor health conditions and died within one year were considered non-migrated. Lastly, Creative Workers killed by the Soviet Union outside of the USSR were categorized as non-migrants.

Research

Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers have been one of the target groups of the population that Soviet Rule has seen as an enemy. They have been one of the targets of repressions. Soviet Rule feared that there was always a chance of an independent Ukrainian art scene developing, as this might have led to the rise of nationalistic views and an establishment of a liberation movement.

This fear can be seen in the policies toward Ukrainian Creative Industries, for example, in the act of dissolution of VAPLITE in 1928 - the most significant Ukrainian Literature Writer's Organisation established in 1926. The dissolution of VAPLITE can be directly linked to the uprising of anti-Moscow-centristic[1] views in the organization. Straight after the dissolution of the VAPLITE, a new organization, "USSR Union of Writers," was established with Maxim Gorky, an open Ukrainophobe, as its head.[2]

This fear is also directly described in NKVD (The People's Commissariat for Internal Affairs) reports on Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers whom they have been spying on for the whole duration of the existence of the Soviet Union.[3] Thousands of reports indicated the nationalistic views of Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers, which often came combined with an accusation of a non-proletarian background.[4]

As a result of the anti-intellectual views of the Soviet Regime, many Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers were executed in the 1930s, primarily in 1937. They would be arrested under false statements, sent to jail, and executed (primarily shot). Two of the most significant places for the burial of the executed would be Sandarmokh, Republic of Karelia, Russia, and Bykivnya, Kyiv, Ukraine.[5] The Soviet Union also prioritized executing Ukrainian intellectuals of Jewish descent over any other ethnic group, executing them with a four times higher probability than Ethnic Ukrainians.[6]

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[1] T. Opryshko, "Polemika VUSPPU y VAPLITE Na Storinkakh Zhurnalu «Hart» (1927–1928rr..), Полеміка ВУСППУ й ВАПЛІТЕ На Сторінках Журналу «Гарт» (1927–1928рр..) [The Polemic of VUSPPU and VAPLITE on the Pages of the Magazine 'Hart' (1927–1928...)]," Вісник ХДАК [Visnyk KhDAK] 44 (2014).

[2] Mykola Soroka, "The Russian-Ukrainian Encounter: Gorky Versus Vynnychenko," Toronto Slavic Quarlery, n.d., http://sites.utoronto.ca/tsq/16/soroka16.shtml.

[3] Unreadable, "'Ahenturne Zvedennia pro Mykolu Khvylovoho Ta Yoho Tvorchist' Агентурне Зведення Про Миколу Хвильового Та Його Творчість [Agency Summary about Mykola Khvylovy and His Work]," Center for Liberation Movement , accessed May 14, 2023, http://avr.org.ua/viewDoc/30112.

[4] Olga Bertelsen, "Spatial Dimensions of Soviet Repressions in the 1930s : The House of Writers," Nottingham eTheses, 2013, https://eprints.nottingham.ac.uk/id/eprint/13390.

[5] Iryna Shtohrin, "Bez Stroku Davnosti. Khto, Yak i Koho Rozstriliav u Sandarmokhu, Без Строку Давності. Хто, Як і Кого Розстріляв у Сандармоху [No Statute of Limitations. Who Shot Whom, How and in Sandarmoh]," Radio Svoboda, 2018, https://www.radiosvoboda.org/a/29582023.html.

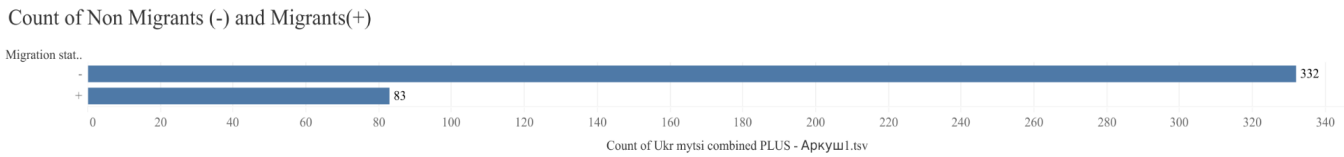
[6] Vladlen Maraiev, "Bykivnia: Koho Rozstriliuvaly Enkavedysty?, Биківня: Кого Розстрілювали Енкаведисти? [Bykivnya: Who Was Shot by Enkavedists?]," Ukrainskyi interes, December 20, 2022, https://uain.press/blogs/1488874-602609.

Since then, there would be another two uprisings of the Ukrainian Creative Industries, one in the fifties during the Khrushchev Thaw, with a new wave of repression later coming in the sixties, which gave this uprising its name - Sixtiers (Shistdesiatnyky), and later during the late 1980s and before the end of the Soviet Rule.

The period from the 1960s would be characterized by constant fighting among many Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers for their liberties and freedom with the support of human rights organizations such as the Ukrainian Helsinki Group and PEN Ukraine. Many Creative Industry Workers would live "double lives" of unofficial artists while producing pieces of Social Realism or working on daytime jobs. However, many of the members of those human rights organizations, as well as Creative Workers, would be imprisoned or repressed.[7]

Due to the rise of repression, many Ukrainian Intellectuals fled the Soviet Union, ensuring a better chance for survival to themselves. Many would continue working as creative industry workers and/or join diaspora organizations.

From the statistics from four sources[8] [three of which we have covered entirely, and one in which we have randomly selected 11 people with a positive migration status], we have come up with a list of a total of 415 Creative Industry Workers who did fit our criteria.



Out of 415 in the statistics Creative Industry Workers, 83 migrated and died during the existence of the Soviet Union, and 332 stayed in the Soviet Union and died there.

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[7] Iryna Shtohrin, “Bez Stroku Davnosti. Khto, Yak i Koho Rozstriliav u Sandarmokhu, Без Строку Давності. Хто, Як і Кого Розстріляв у Сандармоху [No Statute of Limitations. Who Shot Whom, How and in Sandarmoh],” Radio Svoboda, 2018, https://www.radiosvoboda.org/a/29582023.html.

[8] Used entirely:
O. Bazhan, “Shistdesiatnytstvo, Шістдесятництво,” Institute of History of Ukraine, 2013, http://www.history.org.ua/?termin=shistdesjatnytstvo .

O.S. Rublev, “ROZSTRILIaNE VIDRODZhENNIa, РОЗСТРІЛЯНЕ ВІДРОДЖЕННЯ [SHOT REVIVAL],” ENCYCLOPEDIA OF THE HISTORY OF UKRAINE, 1959, http://www.history.org.ua/?termin=Rozstriliane_vidrodzhennia.

“Ukrainski Khudozhnyky, Українські Художники (Ukrainian Artists),” Library of Ukrainian art, Бібліотека українського мистецтва, April 7, 2020, https://uartlib.org/ukrayinski-hudozhniki/.

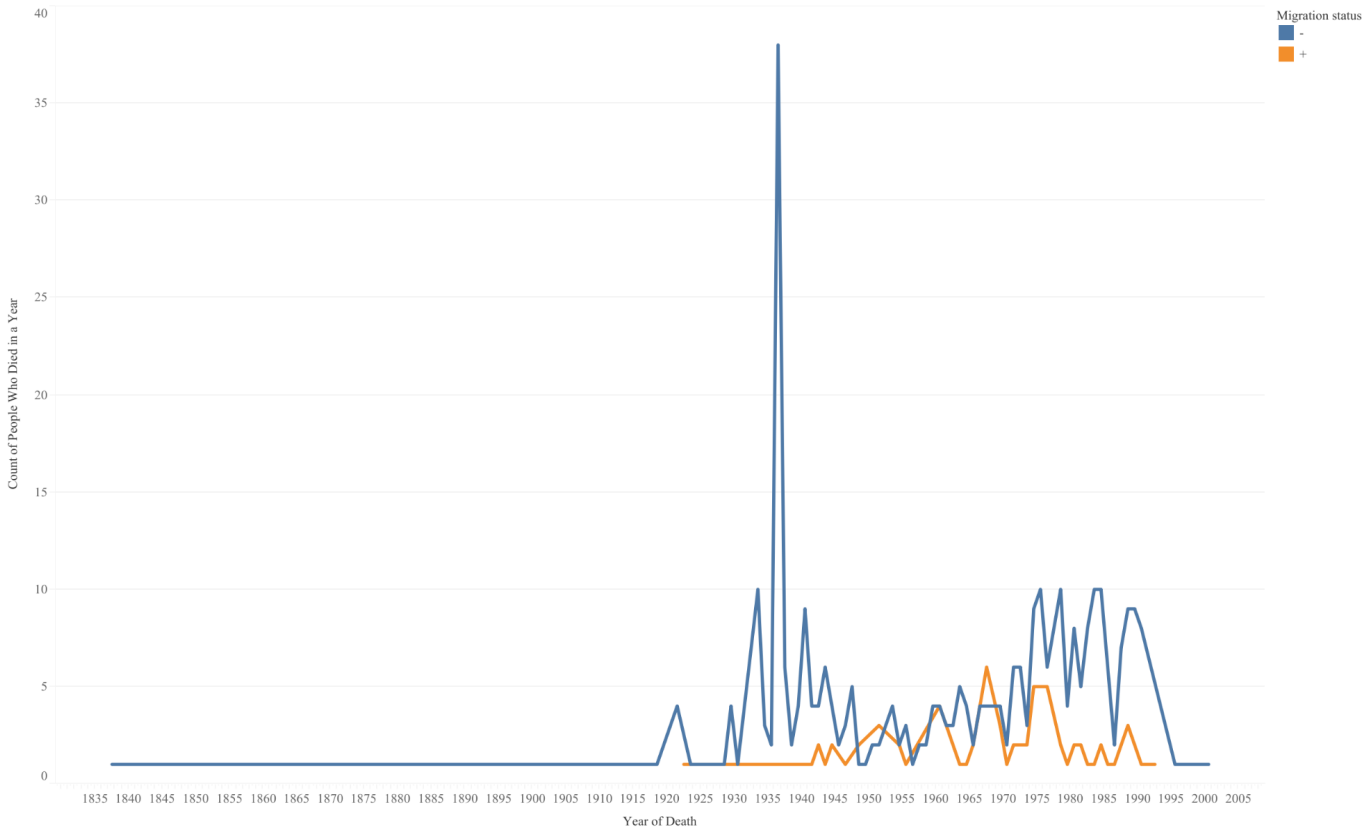
Used for random selection:
O. Astafiev, “Literatura Ukrainskoi Diaspory (Literature of the Ukrainian Diaspora),” Encyclopedia of Modern Ukraine, January 1, 1970, https://esu.com.ua/article-55765.

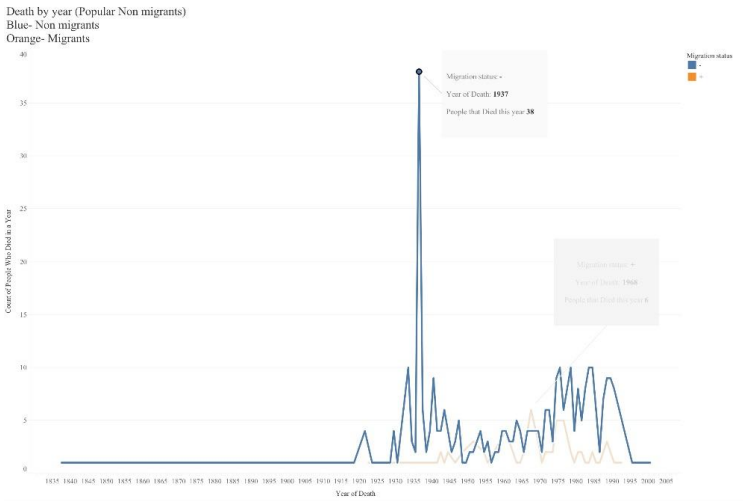
Migration Status to: Avarage Born, Av. Life Lenght, Avarage Death

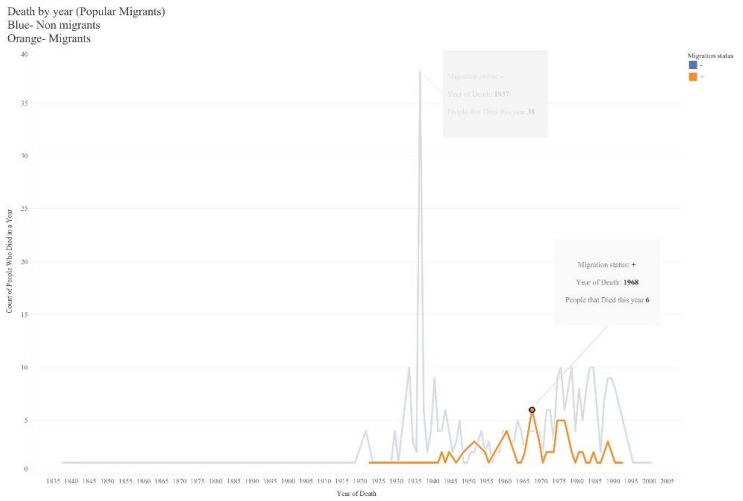
Migration status	Avg. Born	Avg. Died	Avg. Life Length
-	1,899	1,961	63
+	1,895	1,967	72
Migration status			

The Average Year of Birth for the Creative Industry Workers who died in the Soviet Union would be 1899, and for those who died in Immigration, 1895. The Average Year of Death for the Creative Industry Workers who died in the Soviet Union would be 1961, and for those who died in Immigration, 1967. The average life expectancy for the Creative Industry Workers who would die in the Soviet Union would be 63 years, and for those who died in Immigration, 72 years.

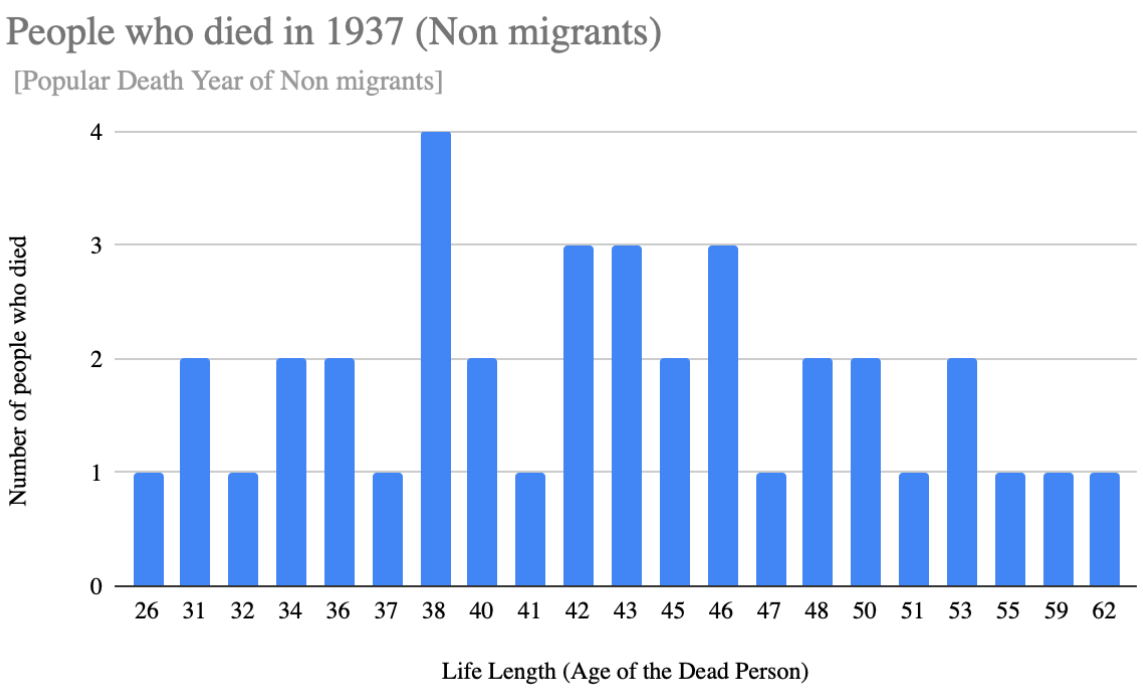
Death by year
Blue- Non migrants
Orange- Migrants



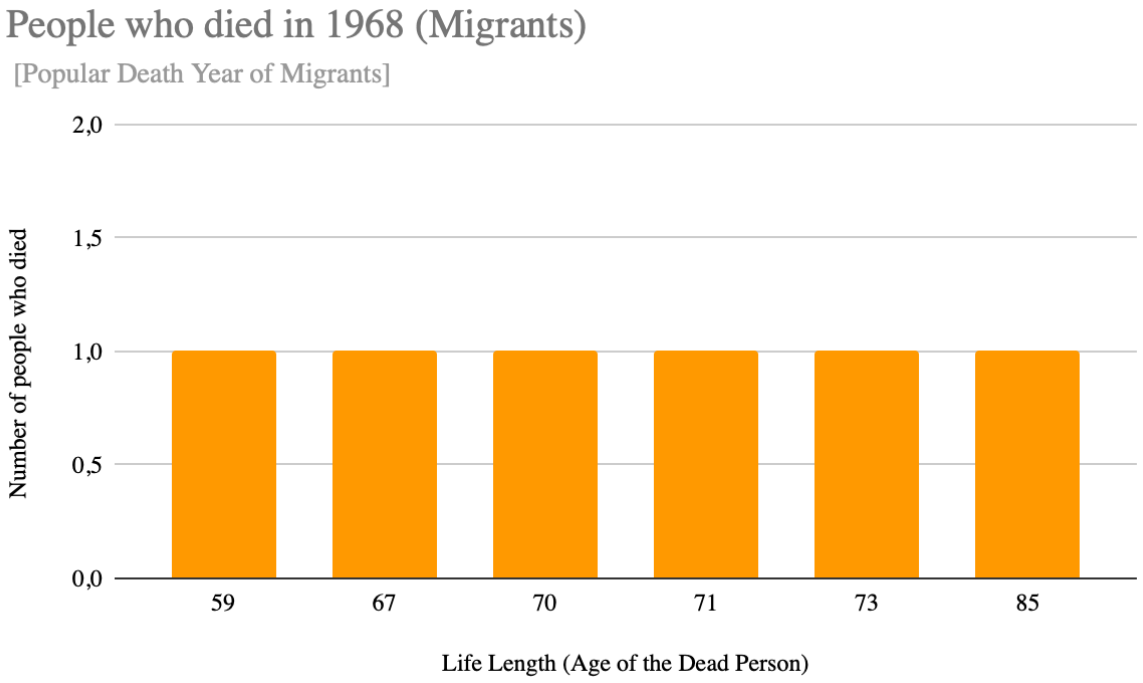




The popular year of death among the Creative Industry Workers who died in the Soviet Union is 1937, and for those who died in Immigration, 1968. What is uncommon between them is the age distribution of people who died in those popular years.



In 1937 the popular age of death amongst the Creative Industry Workers who died in the Soviet Union was 38, with the second popular age of 42,43,46. With the average age of death of 42.In Comparison, only one person in the data from those who did die in migration would die that year at the age of 57 (Sonia Lewitska).



In Comparison, the Creative Industry Workers who died in Immigration at the popular year of death would only die at the ages of 59,67,70,71,73,85, with an average age of death at nearly 71 years old. While at the same year, 4 people from the group who died in USSR died at the ages of 59,63,70, and 79, and an average age of death of 67.75. So although the amount of people in the statics who would die in Immigration is significantly lower, it's safe to assume that the age of death in the popular years of death was much higher amongst them. This could partially indicate the above-mentioned artificial causes of death, such as executions for Creative Industry Workers who died in the Soviet Union.

To conclude

Although there needs to be more analysis of the data on the death of Ukrainian Creative Industry Workers during the period of existence of the USSR, it's safe to say that even with a small amount of data, the evidence of the Great Terror and excessive death of Ukrainian Creative Workers can be seen. The problems which have to be solved in the future are the declassification of reasons for the death and the age of death of many Ukrainian Creative workers (f.e. Alla Morska). For many of the repressed Creative industries, the death dates that were given to the public were fake, for example, in the situation with Les Kurbas, who was executed in 1937 but was officially alive in 1942. Although today we know much more about those cases, it's still clear that not all data was declassified.

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